



Papua New Guinea



Staple crop

Taro is a starchy root vegetable eaten in many Papua New Guinea dishes. It has been cultivated on the islands for thousands of years.

Flamboyant feathers

The eye-catching Raggiana bird of paradise is found widely in the nation's rain forests. It appears on the country's national flag.



Mud masks

To scare away enemies, the tradition of the Asaro people of the eastern highlands is to wear monster masks made of clay.

Tree kangaroo

Deep in Papua New Guinea's rain forests live tree kangaroos. These skilled climbers spend most of their time on trees, eating leaves and fruit.



Sacred architecture

The National Parliament building in Port Moresby is built in the style of a Haus Tambaran, a traditional sacred meeting house.

Colorful mosaics decorate the tall, sweeping facade.



- 178,703 sq miles (462,840 sq km)
- 7.2 million
- Port Moresby
- Tok Pisin, other languages (+800)

Papua New Guinea is a collection of **600 tropical islands**. Most people live in **rural villages**, many of which have their own distinct ways of life.